of the universe. Clearly, there is a need for more honest conversations around the dark side of the Enlightenment, particularly from the perspective of formerly colonised societies, most of which have suffered irreversible all-round harm.

The contemporary and practical relevance of such conversations from an indigenous perspective is the urgent need to acknowledge the Protestant-inspired, race-conscious coloniality of the political structure established by the European coloniser in colonies. The second critical takeaway, in my opinion and in which I am supported by the work of De Roover and others including Mignolo,[38] is that the presumptions of secularity, liberality, neutrality, equality and universality—which are imputed to the Enlightenment and its values—are seriously rebuttable, circumspect and, dare I say, even baseless. As stated earlier, extending such presumptions would be downright dishonest in the context of the relationship between the coloniser and the colonised. Third, in light of the first two conclusions, surviving indigenous civilisations that were formerly colonised have the right to reclaim their worldviews and draw from them to redefine their political landscapes, which impact all aspects of their lives, in particular their right to practise their ways of life without having to prove themselves on the anvils of European values and benchmarks. One cannot underscore enough the importance of this form of agency since despite attaining ‘political independence’, former colonies that became new entrants to the club of nation-states were expected to be mere ‘passive participants’ in the Eurocentric world order.

In this club, concepts, such as nation-statehood and sovereignty, were predefined with no scope for indigenous contribution. Those who did not play by these rules were treated as outliers to the ‘world order’ and subjected to constant judgement stemming from never-ending Reformation-style sanctimony and virtue-signalling, which remains the position till date. Indigenous societies with varied forms of precolonial social and political organisation were expected to rearrange themselves to conform to the definition of nation-statehood, which required the domination of one particular ethno-linguistic or religious group over all others so as to become a largely homogenous ‘nation’ with safe spaces created for ‘minorities’.

To say that this triggered a competitive tussle for identification/creation of ethnicities and ethnic domination in indigenous societies would be an understatement. The ones to suffer the most were plural and diverse